

action could also be in the form of pre-recorded videos to ensure that the buyer can have a real-life shopping experience.

While many individual sellers have started using social media platforms such as Instagram or Facebook to market their wares, a large number of social commerce sites have also mushroomed across the country. Such social commerce platforms are playing a far bigger role than Instagram or Facebook, as they offer a lot of handholding and technology-driven tools to empower their sellers, a majority of who may not have even a basic understanding of the digital ecosystem.

The growing importance of social commerce can be gauged from the fact that earlier this year, a report by consulting major Accenture stated that the global social commerce industry is expected to grow three times as fast as traditional e-commerce to \$1.2 trillion by 2025. It has pegged the current size of global social commerce at \$492 billion.

“Growth is predicted to be driven primarily by GenZ and millennial social media users, accounting for 62 per cent of the global social commerce spending by 2025,” it says in its report, while highlighting the fact that around 3.5 billion people—representing over 44 per cent of the global population—use social media and on average, consumers spend around two and a half hours daily on social media platforms.

THE FRIENDLY NEIGHBOURHOOD SELLER

“We started NE Origins during the pandemic in January last year and in less than a year, we have 400 sellers and are registering a month-on-month growth of 15 per cent in our revenues,” says Rewaj Chettri, Founder & CEO, NE Origins. Catering exclusively to en-

THE PULL FACTOR

- 1 Live one-on-one video chats between buyer and seller
- 2 Chats in regional languages; translate in real-time
- 3 Bargain feature available with mostly non-branded, non-MRP goods on sale
- 4 Videos describing stores, products of sellers
- 5 Same-day delivery, order tracking and quick onboarding

\$1.2

TRILLION

**EXPECTED
SIZE OF THE
GLOBAL SOCIAL
COMMERCE
MARKET
BY 2025**

\$492

BILLION

**CURRENT
SIZE OF THE
GLOBAL SOCIAL
COMMERCE
MARKET**

SOURCE ACCENTURE

trepreneurs from the north-eastern states, NE Origins has on its platform sellers with many indigenous products like wild honey from Nagaland, turmeric from Meghalaya and black rice from Manipur, among other things.

While one may feel that NE Origins has a very unique proposition, hence it has been able to clock such traction in terms of on-boarding new sellers, the unanimous view prevalent among social commerce platforms is that there is a largely untapped segment of sellers just waiting to initiate their social commerce journey. “We have 700,000 stores registered on our platform of which 200,000 are active on an average every month. We have been registering a growth of around 20 per cent on a monthly basis,” says Jasmeet Thind, Co-founder of Coutloot, which features among the largest home-grown social commerce platforms, according to data from Tracxn. In terms of sales, Coutloot is doing around ₹65 crore every month with more than 700,000 transactions, adds Thind.

A similar story is developing at Indore-based Kiko, which has turned social commerce into a live video shopping experience. “The Kiko Live section was launched around January end and we have already crossed 10,000 sellers on our platform. We are signing up around 200-300 sellers every day. We might sign up 10,000 more in this month alone,” says Alok Chawla, Co-founder & COO, Kiko. “In terms of number of buyer-seller interactions happening daily, we are seeing 1,000 calls per day where the call time exceeds a minute. Currently, we are doing ₹50 lakh a month GMV (gross merchandise value) but the real number would be much higher, as sellers have the option of using third-party payment gateways as well.”

Incidentally, the pandemic has proved to be a great enabler for the social commerce segment, a fact